A DRAUGHT OF THE EASTERN LAKES

The Canoe Traveller's Network

The instructor's key / Ordinary tandem team / Double carries / Model assumptions, not observed travel times

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I. THREE PRE-DESIGNED JOURNEYS

A - Inner circuit / 13.25-27.25 h

Clearwater - West Pike - Pine - Little Caribou - Caribou - Clearwater

B - Eastern circuit / 19.5-40.75 h

Clearwater - West Pike - East Pike - John - Little John - McFarland
Pine - Little Caribou - Caribou - Clearwater

C - Rose out and back / 17.25-33.25 h

Clearwater - Mountain - Watap - Rove - Rose; return by the same chain

Totals are moving + handling hours, not days or daily targets. Rest, camps, queues, difficult weather and windbound waits add time. Both directions use the same broad scenario envelope; wind direction changes which end of the range is plausible.

II. HOW THE HOURS ARE RECKONED

Paddle: geographic water-path distance, plus 15-30% indirect travel; 20-35% on more winding paths. Divide by 4 km/h (favourable) or 2 km/h (adverse but travelable). These are teaching assumptions.

Carry: 2 loaded walks at 2-3 km/h, 1 return at 3-4 km/h, plus 10-20 minutes of handling per connection. One rod = 5.0292 m.

Bounds round outward to quarter hours. A 0-0.25 h label means a brief nonzero leg. All rod counts are derived, not official counts.

III. HIGH GROUND & UNCERTAINTY

H01 ~600 m / near Clearwater

H04 ~625 m / near Clearwater

H08 ~620 m / near West Pike

H10 ~600 m / near Pine

H12 ~600 m / near East Pike

These are bare-earth terrain candidates, not verified visible peaks. Tree cover can obscure them. Their schematic placement is illustrative; use the separate geographic project for true positions and bearings.

Carry a: USFS line is incomplete; published digitized GPX supplies an approximate full passage.
Carries h and i: published sketches, no matching USFS geometry. Water links f and m are not carries.

Clearwater-Deer was omitted: the recorded trail stops short of the lakes. Deer connects via Caribou.

Rose is a terminal branch. Its T point, like those on Deer, Alder and Crystal, is a hypothetical water turnaround, not a campsite or landing.

SOURCES & REPRODUCTION

MN DNR waters / USFS trails / MnGeo terrain
Friends of BWCA digitized loop / Parks Canada history
Timing context: Poudre Paddlers; NPS wind variability
Full citations and limitations: docs/SOURCES.md